



For Aashna Khurana, art gives colour to otherwise muted shades. The walls of her living room, and the rest of the house, hang art in abstract, modern and traditional forms, painted by various artists during a three-day symposium they hosted at Karma Lakelands. There are still the old traditional users who go for the masters. But designer Devika Mehra is part of the younger bunch of designers who appreciate the Young Art Selector Programme. They accompany owners to contemporary art shows to help them select art. “Many are actively looking at art as an investment” she says. They buy pieces at ₹75,000 to ₹3 lakh each.

As numbers grow, designers have resorted to using artificial intelligence and supply chain lines to cater to the growing demands of new buyers. The furniture

fairs of Milan and the factories of China provide the mass market basics for many young buyers. Quality is a criterion, though. Money is not. For some designers, this is a chance to create design signatures, and they refuse to include any deviations from their style. The new entrants to luxury cadres go for them because of the bragging rights they offer them. For many others it is a process of hand holding, education and listening to the clients. Whatever the thought, they are all contributing to the image of a new, vibrant and confident luxury interiors that draws as much from the Chola bronzes that Sunita Kohli chooses to the European masters that Shailja Vohora and her team study meticulously. Money and geography are no barriers. The only baseline is affluence and comfort. **BT**